Sledge Hammer



Category: **Hand Tools - Striking & Digging** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 4 labs

Covers these lab items: Mash Hammer; Sledge Hammer

What it is used for

To strike, break, or drive suitable materials using a sledge hammer. To apply controlled impact while maintaining a secure grip and stable working position.

Main parts

- Hammer head
- Handle
- Head-to-handle joint
- Grip surface

Before you start

1. Select a hammer with suitable head weight and handle length.
2. Inspect the head, handle, and joint for cracks or looseness.
3. Check that the striking surface and workpiece are suitable.
4. Clear the swing area and ensure bystanders are at a safe distance.
5. Wear safety glasses, safety footwear, and other required PPE.

How to use

1. Stand with stable footing and maintain clear space around the body.
2. Hold the handle firmly with both hands where appropriate.
3. Position the hammer head over the intended striking point.
4. Swing in a controlled motion and strike squarely.
5. Allow the head to contact the workpiece without glancing blows where possible.
6. Reposition the workpiece or tool only after the hammer is lowered safely.
7. Inspect the workpiece and hammer after the task.

⚠ Safety

- Never use a hammer with a loose head or cracked handle.
- Keep hands and feet away from the impact zone.
- Do not strike hardened steel surfaces unless the tool is designed for that use.
- Wear eye protection against flying fragments.
- Do not swing when anyone is within the striking area.

Care & storage

- Clean the head and handle after use.
- Inspect the joint and handle regularly.
- Replace damaged handles or remove unsafe tools from service.
- Store securely in a dry place.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using an unsuitable hammer weight.
- Striking at an angle and causing the head to glance off.
- Working with a loose head or damaged handle.
- Failing to clear bystanders from the swing area.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.